

PHP String Functions – Smart Summary Guide

A concise and practical guide to the most commonly used PHP string functions, with syntax, explanations, and examples.

strlen()

Returns the length of a string.

```
$str = "Hello";  
echo strlen($str); // Output: 5
```

str_word_count()

Counts the number of words in a string.

```
$str = "Hello World PHP";  
echo str_word_count($str); // Output: 3
```

strrev()

Reverses a string.

```
echo strrev("hello"); // Output: olleh
```

strpos()

Finds the position of the first occurrence of a substring in a string.

```
echo strpos("Hello world", "world"); // Output: 6
```

str_replace()

Replaces all occurrences of a search string with a replacement string.

```
echo str_replace("world", "PHP", "Hello world"); // Output: Hello PHP
```

substr()

Returns a part of a string.

```
$str = "Hello World";  
echo substr($str, 0, 5); // Output: Hello
```

substr_replace()

Replaces text within a portion of a string.

```
echo substr_replace("Hello World", "PHP", 6); // Output: Hello PHP
```

strtoupper()

Converts a string to uppercase.

```
echo strtoupper("php"); // Output: PHP
```

strtolower()

Converts a string to lowercase.

```
echo strtolower("HELLO"); // Output: hello
```

ucfirst()

Converts the first character of a string to uppercase.

```
echo ucfirst("php"); // Output: Php
```

ucwords()

Converts the first character of each word to uppercase.

```
echo ucwords("hello world php"); // Output: Hello World Php
```

trim()

Removes whitespace or other characters from both sides of a string.

```
$str = " Hello World ";  
echo trim($str); // Output: Hello World
```

ltrim()

Removes whitespace or other characters from the left side of a string.

```
echo ltrim(" Hello"); // Output: Hello
```

rtrim()

Removes whitespace or other characters from the right side of a string.

```
echo rtrim("Hello "); // Output: Hello
```

explode()

Splits a string into an array by a separator.

```
$arr = explode(" ", "Hello PHP World");  
print_r($arr);
```

implode()

Joins array elements into a string.

```
$arr = ["Hello", "PHP", "World"];  
echo implode(" ", $arr); // Output: Hello PHP World
```

strcmp()

Compares two strings (case-sensitive).

```
echo strcmp("Hello", "hello"); // Output: non-zero (different)
```

strcasecmp()

Compares two strings (case-insensitive).

```
echo strcasecmp("Hello", "hello"); // Output: 0 (same)
```

htmlspecialchars()

Converts special characters to HTML entities.

```
echo htmlspecialchars("<b>PHP</b>"); // Output: &lt;b&gt;PHP&lt;/b&gt;
```

addslashes()

Adds backslashes before certain characters.

```
echo addslashes("I'm learning PHP"); // Output: I\'m learning PHP
```

str_repeat()

Repeats a string a specified number of times.

```
echo str_repeat("Hi ", 3); // Output: Hi Hi Hi
```

nl2br()

Inserts HTML line breaks before all newlines in a string.

```
echo nl2br("Hello\nWorld"); // Output: Hello<br>World
```